

behalf when an anonymous donor contributed the funds for her children's tuition and books. The donations continued through their entire high-school careers and often included enough to cover even field trips and special projects.

The provision had already been made, but she needed to "believe" God for it. Too often Christians borrow to do what they themselves desire, and expect God to rescue them when the bills arrive. To "believe" requires faith; to charge is presumption.

Another large expense under miscellaneous can be child care. Child care is a disproportionately large portion of a single parent's budget. Quite often, there is no alternative available except to pay the cost and rebudget elsewhere. Until local churches begin to recognize this as a responsibility and a necessity, there is very little that can be done to lighten this burden.

CATEGORY 9: SAVINGS

This savings is not allocated to any specific needs. About 5 percent of your net spendable income should be put aside for expenses that cannot be anticipated.

There is nothing wrong with having some savings. In fact, it is a requirement for most people. The few exceptions are those people to whom God says, "Do not save, but rely on Me from day to day." As Solomon wrote, "There is precious treasure and oil in the dwelling of the wise, but a foolish man swallows it up" (Proverbs 21:20).

It is not unspiritual to save, nor does it represent a lack of faith. The question I often ask of those who believe savings is wrong is, "Which represents better stewardship: to borrow at 18 percent to buy the things that wear out, or to save and then buy them without credit?" It is important that you budget some savings. Otherwise, the use of credit becomes a lifelong necessity, and debt a way of life. Your savings will allow you to purchase with cash and to shop for the best buys, irrespective of the store.

Many families fail to save because they think that the